



Google TV

Google TV Tips and Tricks

TVs aren't that dumb anymore!

Deepak Singh | deepak@digit.in

Google TV is one of the most popular software platforms for TVs. Built on top of Android, it aims to simplify the process of finding content to watch. Android as the base system also implies better app support, better ecosystem advantages, and more flexibility for power users. However, if you are switching from more feature-rich TV software like WebOS or Tizen OS, it might feel a bit barebones and bland. Here are a few tips and tricks to help keep things exciting.

GOOGLE TV VS ANDROID TV

As part of a Google strategy, the

Android TV interface has now been replaced by Google TV. If you purchased your TV in the last couple of years, it probably came with Google TV out of the box. Google TV interface is similar to Android TV but focuses more on content recommendations. All the Google TV tips and tricks we discuss will also apply to Android TVs.

Best Google TV Tips and Tricks that you must try

Let's now talk about some of the things that you can try on your new Google TV.



Apps only mode

If you are not into recom-

mendations, you can switch to App Only mode to speed up your Google TV performance. This removes all the clutter and leaves only your apps on the home screen. To enable Apps Only mode:

- Go to the Google TV home screen.
- Select "Settings".
- Choose "Accounts & Sign In".
- Select your profile.
- Look for "Apps only mode" and turn it on.

This also means you will be eliminating the "Continue watching" roster which I personally find quite useful.



Remap buttons on your remote

Button Mapper is a very popular app that can be used to customise the buttons on the remote of your Google TV. You can remap these buttons to launch apps, shortcuts, or perform custom actions with a single press, double tap, or long press of the button.

This is a great way to make use of extra buttons on your Google TV or even to remap hotkeys to apps that you use frequently. You can pay Rs. 190 to unlock the Pro tier, which allows access to more functions.